

## Interview Schedule: Cultural Class and Romantic Relationships

### **I. Introduction (1 to 2.5 minutes)**

1. Thank you, Brad, for agreeing to this interview with me, and for taking the time to do so! As I mentioned in our previous interactions, I'm interested in exploring how an individual's background and experiences influence their social and romantic life. Now, I want to emphasize that there are no right or wrong answers here. I'm simply looking for your personal perspective. Please rest assured that your identity will remain confidential, and I'll be using a pseudonym for your name in my notes. So with our introduction out of the way, let's get this interview started, shall we?

### **II. Background and Current Situation (8 minutes)**

1. To start us off, could you tell me a bit about the path that led to your current role as a professor here in Waco?
  - *Probes:* Where did you grow up? What did your parents do for a living when you were young?
2. How would you describe your current social life or the types of activities you enjoy in your free time?
  - *Probes:* Who do you spend most of your time with outside of work? What do you look for in a social setting to feel comfortable or "at home"?
3. When you're in a professional or social setting, what are the things (like interests, humor, ways of talking, etc.) that make you feel like you really "fit in" with a group?
  - *Probes:* Have you ever been in a situation where you felt you *didn't* fit in because of those factors?

### **III. Romantic Preferences and Cultural Capital Signifiers (12 minutes)**

1. When you first meet someone in a romantic context, what are some of the initial things you find yourself noticing or looking for?
  - *Probes:* How much do you think things like their education or career path influence that first impression?
2. Please describe, as best you can, what "compatibility" means to you in a relationship?
  - *Probes:* In your experience, how important is it to share a similar upbringing or set of "tastes" (food, art, hobbies, etc.)?

3. Can you describe a time when you were dating someone and felt a "cultural gap" in your connection, even if you both had similar jobs or incomes? If not, do you have any friends or family members who have experienced this?
  - *Probes:* What specifically happened to make you feel that way? How did it affect how you saw the future of that relationship?
4. Have you ever felt like an "outsider" in a romantic context because of your professional or educational background?
  - *Probes:* Can you think of a specific moment or place where that happened? How did you respond?
5. In your opinion, do you think there are "unwritten rules" in the dating world about who is considered a "good match" for someone?
  - *Probes:* Do you think people are generally aware of these rules, or do they just "happen" naturally?
6. Looking back, how do you think your own background (your education and career journey) has shaped what you find attractive in a partner?
  - *Probes:* Do you find yourself drawn to people with similar life trajectories as yours? Why do you think that is?

#### **IV. Wrap-Up (5 minutes)**

1. "Is there anything else important about this topic (how class or culture affects dating) that you feel is important to mention that we've yet to discuss?"

#### **V. Conclusion - Demographic Questions (2.5 minutes)**

1. What year were you born? And your significant other?
2. What is your current marital and parental status?
3. What is the highest degree you have earned?
4. What racial and ethnic group(s) do you identify with?
5. Income (pick a letter): "For my statistical analysis, I need to know the letter that best describes your total pre-tax household income: **A** (Under \$30k), **B** (under \$60k), **C** (under \$100k), **D** (under \$200k), or **E** (Over \$200k)?"
6. Is this a single or dual source of income?